

INTRODUCTION

Good afternoon Mam, my name is swaraj Gawande and I am from Amravati district Maharashtra, I have completed my B. Tech in mechanical engineering from viit Pune and currently working as a programmer analyst in cognizant technology solutions in quality assurance domain.

Currently I am working in API testing project for an us based insurance company where I used postman and swagger to validate the functionality and the reliability of API.

So, what I do on the daily basis is to involve in all the testing related activities, data mapping calls, test cases development, test data preparation, test environment setup, and understand the business requirements by SM or test lead,

After creating a test data, we have to get it approved from the business unit or by our SM, once they approved then and only then we began our functional testing and validate the functionality API and report the defects in Jira

as you i have just completed one year in cognizant why do you want to leave your company?

I am grateful for the opportunities I've had at Cognizant over the past year. I've gained valuable experience in quality assurance, automation testing, and teamwork, which have helped me grow professionally. However, I feel that I am now at a point where I want to challenge myself further and explore new opportunities that align more closely with my long-term career goals.

Specifically, I am looking for an environment where I can work on diverse and innovative projects, learn cutting-edge technologies, and take on more responsibilities. While I appreciate my current role, I believe a move will allow me to grow technically and contribute more effectively.

It's not about leaving Cognizant but about taking the next step

How TO HANDLE PRESSUER?

According to me handling and releasing a pressure involve a combination of mindset, time management and personal technique

- 1.prioritize the task based on the deadlines.
- 2taking brakes, listening to music, talking with someone exercise,meditation,go for a walk
- 3.having clear communication with developers, stakeholders and team met
- 4.take some time and be relax and recharge
- 5.always focus on quality even in under pressure never compromise the quality. Sticked to the planned process

PROJECT EXPLANATION

My project was for a client in the insurance domain, specifically RLUS, which sells policies to farmers in the U.S.

RLUS sends us an XML 103 document containing policy details like owner ,insured, Payor like this all type of party details and also it contains lots of data regarding to each policy. Our job is to update this XML into the FAST SYSTEM which also a third party to us and ensure the data is synced correctly.

We update and validate the data in DynamoDB and ODH tables to ensure the policy details are consistent across systems.

Every time data is updated, an event is generated and stored in an S3 bucket. I validate these events to ensure accuracy.

I tested 7 out of the 11 APIs used in different flows. These APIs handle tasks like updating data, syncing databases, and reflecting changes in the UI. I used Postman to send requests, validate API responses, and ensure proper database updates.

I also worked on a specific API for policy document uploads. Customers upload documents, which I converted into Base64 format to validate the document upload and flow functionality.

My role focused on testing the entire flow to ensure all systems were properly integrated and working as expected, from API calls to database updates and event validation

Tell me about a time when you were working on multiple projects simultaneously. How did you manage your time effectively?

1.first and important thing is to prioritize the task and identify the critical task that need more time and prioritize it with the deadlines.

2.timeblocks I will divide my time into bocks to ignore the distraction

3.task breakdown I will divide the critical task into a small part

4.clear communication: I keep communication open between my teammate, stakeholders keeping everyone informed and aligned.

5. I schedule regular review sessions to assess progress and make necessary adjustments.

Roles and responsibilities

- 1 to deliver the quality product to the end user
2. to review, write and update the test cases as per client requirements
- 3.proritize the testing activities'
- 4.report the defect
- 5.collabrate with developers to resolve the issue
- 6.perform the regression when changes are made

Tell me about a time when you had to work under pressure.

Answer: During a release cycle, a critical bug was identified just a day before deployment. The issue impacted a core feature, and there was significant pressure to resolve it quickly. I collaborated with the developer to analyze the root cause, retested the fix thoroughly, and ensured the release went smoothly. To handle the pressure, I stayed calm, prioritized tasks, and focused on clear communication with the team, which helped us deliver on time without compromising quality.

How do you handle conflict?

Answer: **I believe in addressing conflict through open communication and mutual respect.** For instance, when a developer once disagreed with a defect I logged, I arranged a meeting to discuss the issue. I presented evidence from my tests and listened to their perspective. We eventually reached a consensus, understanding the impact of the defect and the need to fix it. **By focusing on the problem rather than personal differences, we resolved the conflict efficiently.**

How do you work as part of a team?

Answer: I value collaboration and clear communication in a team setting. In one project, I worked closely with developers, testers, and business analysts to ensure smooth integration of a new module. I made sure to share regular updates, document findings, and support others when needed. This cooperative approach helped us achieve our goals efficiently and built strong team relationships.

What is your approach to problem-solving?

Answer: My approach to problem-solving is methodical. First, I analyse the problem to understand its root cause. Then, I brainstorm potential solutions and evaluate their feasibility. Finally, I implement the solution while keeping stakeholders informed. For example, when a performance issue arose during testing, I used monitoring tools to pinpoint the bottleneck and collaborated with the team to optimize the code, resolving the issue effectively.

What are your goals for your career?

Answer: My short-term goal is to deepen my technical expertise in automation testing and learn advanced tools like Selenium and API testing frameworks. Long-term, I aim to take on a leadership role where I can mentor others, drive innovative testing strategies, and contribute to delivering high-quality products that make a real impact.

What are the key challenges have you faced during the testing?

- 1.limited documentation most of the time there is no proper documentation
- 2.also the stability of the environment some time we have to test in multiple environments, so stability of environment is the key challenge.
- 3.test data preparation and injection to the ODH table
- 4.wait for the timing cycle to complete to reflect the transaction on the UI and API response
- 5.lack of communication
- 6.release early and we get the limited time to test we can go with the risk based approach

How do you handle the conflicts?

The first and foremost thing is to analyse why it happens

I have to acknowledge the perspective of others

For me to address the conflict the best way is open communication and have a clear understanding I have to make him understand we are chasing the same goal. I think best can be achieved only while working with team .

Prioritize the quality over personal differences then and then only we can be able to deliver a quality product

Can you share an example of a project where testing did not go as planned? What would you do differently?

1. First of all I will strengthen the testing related activity
2. Create a comprehensive test plan include detail test cases and scenario, make a test strategy, identify a scope in early stage
3. 3.in early stage I prioritize the testing
4. Maintain open and transparent communication with the development team to address issues promptly.
5. Regularly review test cases and strategies to identify potential gaps and improve coverage.

How to end the interview?

Thank you so much mam for you time and consideration and I am really looking forward to hear from you soon.

Salary Negotiation?

I am happy to discuss salary, but I would love to know from your end what's the budget you have in your mind for this role?

If release date is shifted earlier?

1.i have to analyses the impact of date change

I have to change my whole testing plan

I have to use the risk-based testing approach

I have to test the major and critical functionalities that are mostly used

. I have to ask and get helped from the developers in such situation

And if needed we have to onboard the new resource for the help not a new member but member from same team who do not require a learning curve so that we can test all the high level test cases and we can pushed it for the release.

Have you dealt with stakeholders who pressured you to skip certain test cases to meet a deadline? How did you handle it?

- 1.i will explain them the risk of skipping this test cases
- 2.after that I will execute the high priority test case
- 3.and document the skipped ones for the future reference testing.
4. This ensured delivery while addressing potential risks later.

What do you enjoy most about QA and automation testing?

- 1.I enjoy ensuring software quality before it reaches to the end user
- 2.I also enjoy automating the repetitive task this gives me a productive approach while doing the testing
3. Finding and fixing issues before they reach users gives me a sense of accomplishment.
- 4.and last It give me a sense of responsibility that I am the person responsible for the quality delivery of application and give a good experience to user.

I worked on an insurance domain project where I was responsible for API testing using Postman. My first task was to understand the requirement from our manager and the onshore team through regular calls. They guided us on how to trigger specific events for testing.

Once I understood the requirement, I created test data in both the Dev and QA environments. Our company shared an XML 103 document that contained all the policy-related details like payor, beneficiary, insured person, premium amount, billing mode and method, etc.

Using the data shared by developers, I triggered API requests in Postman and verified if the data was correctly reflected in our third-party application called FAST, which has a dashboard to view policy updates.

Apart from FAST, I also validated that the same data is stored correctly in DynamoDB. I always verified the API response – including the status code, response body, and headers.

For every event generated (like policy status change, document upload, billing method update), I had to prepare test cases and check whether the correct event was triggered and stored properly.

I also had to check the AWS S3 bucket after each event to make sure the expected event file or data was actually generated and uploaded correctly.

Our project architecture was divided into three layers: Experience layer (EXP), System layer (SYS), and PRC layer. I tested mainly from the Experience layer, which internally calls the lower-level APIs. So I ensured that data was flowing correctly across all layers and being processed as expected."

Describe a time when a developer disagreed with a defect you logged. How did you resolve the situation?

In testing this usually happens developer thinks this is minor bug and didn't affect the functionality but as a tester I believed I need to be very clear with the client requirement suppose developer is not agreeing the defect then I would provide a clear evidence to the developers such as logs, screenshots for specific use cases to demonstrate the impact of defect.

2.Acknowledge the developers' perspective and tried to understand their reasoning

3.i involve the SM, PL, senior developers to provide a support.

4.i will tell them the negative impact of this from users perspective.

Have you faced a situation where your testing process uncovered a major issue just before release? What steps did you take?

Immediately I have to escalate the issue to the developers .

Involved PM,TL about this

Collaborate and work closely with the developers to find the root cause of the issue.

Have a clear communication with the stakeholders

Discuss the potential risk associated with this issue

Propose a decision based on the impact analysis if there is hotfix then we can immediately patch the defect after release

Suppose there is blocker then we have to extend the deadlines and if defect is not that major so we can move with it and fixed it in future testing.

Always prioritize quality and user experience over meeting deadlines. Stakeholders are generally more understanding of a delayed release than a defective product reaching to end-users

8. Describe a time when the requirements for a project changed significantly. How did you adjust your testing strategy?

1.First task is to understand the new requirement clearly if not understand then connects with the stakeholders and it clear .

2.collabrate with the developers to understand the scope of new functionality.

3.write the new test cases and verify it is a independent module or dependant one .

4.if it is dependant then I need to check wether it is affecting the existing functionality or not .I have to do regression testing

5.Also I need to prioritize the test cases add the new test cases

Suppose any new functionality is added in a existing software how should I test what should be my approach?

1. Review the functional and technical requirements of the new feature.
2. Understand its scope, functionality and dependency
3. Identify the modules, components, or systems affected by the new functionality.
4. Check the dependency on the existing functionality
5. Update the test plan
6. Define the high level scenarios for the new functionality
7. Ensure both the new functionality and existing functionality are thoroughly tested.
8. Prioritize testing based on criticality and potential risks.
9. Write the new test cases to accommodate the new functionality
10. Modify the existing test case
11. Check for the integration testing and write the test cases for that
12. Check for the invalid or negative test case using invalid data